Chirper

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X: I think I've activated it!

Somewhere in the Suitcase

The Left: Dr. X, making the Chirper user-friendly is one of its key design goals.

X: Of course. I was merely pondering how a Chirper transformed from a hydrogen cell might differ from its peers.

X: Do its functions perfectly correspond with its physical form? Or does it retain some characteristics of its original composition?

The Right: Empirically, an entity's physical form is a manifestation of its essence.

X: Therefore, if two entities share the same form, can we claim their essences are one and the same?

X: In that case, the line between man-made machines and the Awakened truly becomes blurred.

The Left: Dr. Vertin introduced us to the concept of the Awakened.

The Left: These Awakened evoke a feeling of ... kindred connection within me. A sensation I've just discovered.

X: Ms. Radio would be overjoyed to hear that. She might even bloom another flower.

The Right: Radio ... bloom.

X: The creation of life is always a miracle, don't you think? The gap between inorganic matter and life isn't that wide.

The Left: Inorganic matter ... life.

X: Hey, I just thought of something! What if this Chirper someday gains consciousness too?

X: All right then, future Ms. or Mr. Chirper, let's keep this recording short so you have more space for your own thoughts.

X: This on-off mechanism is remarkably accessible. We ought to adopt it for our future designs here in Laplace.

The Left: According to previous data, Dr. X usually prefers unnecessarily complicated designs.

X: But they need to be interesting. No matter how complex a Rube Goldberg machine is, it shouldn't contain any unimaginative, redundant components.

The Left: Understood. Data has been updated.

Chirper: ...

Chirper: ..."Data" ...

Chirper: ..."Updated" ...